

user interface.

The phone supports all the latest features such as MMS, EMS, polyphonic tones and downloadable games. It also supports WAP 2.0, GPRS and HSCSD, not to forget the IrDA port that can be used for transferring files between devices. The phone also supports POP3 e-mail clients for sending and receiving mails with attachments. The only one thing that is missing is the PIM functionality, you can insert reminders but a full weekly or monthly view is absent.

The phone handles speech with aplomb and all in all, is a feature rich phone for an extremely irresistible price.

Sony Ericsson T600

Price: Rs 9,995 B+

This is the most compact and the cutest phone to make it to our comparison test. The phone has a two-tone finish and is available in two colours—Marine Blue and Moonlight Silver. The keys sport a silver finish with a striking blue backlight, that is visible in all the lighting conditions.

The phone has a well-sized, high resolution LCD display that can display four lines of text, and is lit with a xenon backlight, producing pastel blue lighting. The keypad, though small, in size, is quite effective due to an efficient key layout that gives access to all the required features with a few clicks. The menu structure is very simple to navigate with two dedicated navigation keys and one menu key. The grouping of various features in the menu is impeccable—all the features are where they should be. The phone has some decent features—a 250 capacity address book, speed dial setting for 8 numbers and ring tones association for 10 names. It supports concatenated SMS, group sending, EMS and SMS chat. It also features PIM functionality, where you can switch between a monthly and weekly calendar view, assign various types of events to a particular day and also set alarms for particular times.

Other frills include a calculator, currency converter, stopwatch and five exciting games. The signal reception was not up to the mark—the phone experienced speech loss and voice breaks in the interiors of our building.

The T600 phone is targeted at the fairer sex and does not have what it takes to be a business phone. Though it is probably the smallest phone in the market, it fails to justify the price tag of Rs 9,995 with its limited bag of features.



Sony Ericsson T68i

Price: Rs 14,995 B

This phone has been around for a year, and gives strong competition to the high-end cell phones, with its features, performance and terrific price.

The phone has an aesthetically appealing design that would set many a heart afire. The use of matt-silver colour for the body and metallic blue for the bezel make it stand out. The keypad is ergonomically laid out with no key cramping. The menu can be navigated using the slick joystick, which provides excellent audible feedback when pressed or tucked sideways. Two other soft keys also help in menu navigation.

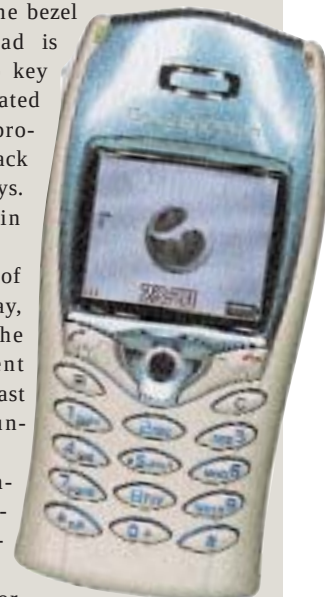
The most noticeable feature of T68i is the 8-bit colour LCD display, which displays 5 lines of text. The 256-colour screen has excellent brightness and gives good contrast even when exposed to direct sunlight.

This phone comes with a mammoth address book entry capability of 500, apart from the additional SIM capacity. As far as messaging goes, the phone has support for MMS, EMS, POP3 e-mail client and mobile chat. Similarly when it comes to data transfer and connectivity, no other phone offers as much as this phone. The phone has IrDA, Bluetooth, cable connectivity, WAP 2, GPRS or HSCSD. An external camera can also be attached to it via the camera port at the base of the phone.

The phone also has an excellent calendar and PIM functionality, making it an ideal business companion. It comes bundled with 8 games, 32 ring tones, good screensavers and pretty decent themes. All these features provide excellent personalising options.

Though the manufacturer claims 12 hours of talk time, we expect it to be around 6 hours, which is still commendable, not to mention a stellar standby time of 320 hrs. The phone shows decent signal reception but has exceptional voice clarity with hardly any broken speech or other disturbances when talking.

The T68i is an excellent cell phone that will appeal to people from all spheres of life and, with an aggressive pricing of just Rs 14,995, leaves all other phones in this category chewing its dust.



WE RECOMMEND

Those Who did not Make it

Though we tried to get all the brands for the comparison, some were regrettably left out.

- Samsung failed to send in their products even after continuous follow ups.
- Philips has discontinued all their Fisio models and is scheduling a launch of new models somewhere in the second quarter of 2003.
- Though Panasonic has a slew of models on offer, they managed

to send in only the GD55 model, without the charger, due to which we could not test it.

- The first Indian brand V K Munoth did not wish to get their models tested right now.